

"My body,
clean and
whole, never ...
corrupted ...
**today must
be ... burnt
to ashes!"**

JOAN OF ARC, AS QUOTED BY JEAN TOUTMOUILLE AT HER
POSTHUMOUS RETRIAL, 1449

HEROINE OF WAR

Born in 1412 to a peasant family in Domrémy, France, Joan of Arc believed she had been chosen by God to defeat the English in the protracted Hundred Years' War. Acting on this divine guidance, she led the French to victory against the English at Orléans in 1429. However, two years later Joan was captured in Compiègne and burned at the stake by the English. They accused her of sorcery, which constituted a charge of heresy. Despite her short life, Joan's bravery later inspired many artistic works, such as Hermann Anton Stilke's 1843 oil painting of her in battle (right). Joan became a symbol of France and was canonized as a Roman Catholic saint in 1920.

